THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 02

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

Water seems to be everywhere, yet the amount that humans can actually drink is small. About ninety-seven per cent of the Earth's water is in the oceans and is too salty for use. Most of the remainder is frozen at the poles or lies deep underground. A very small portion in rivers, lakes and shallow wells serves the needs of billions of people.

In many Indian cities, taps run for an hour or two each day, and families store water in tanks and buckets. In villages, women and children often walk long distances to fetch a pot or two. When rain fails, wells dry up and farmers lose their crops. These are not distant problems; they touch every home.

Saving water begins with small, ordinary acts. A tap left running while brushing teeth wastes several litres in a minute. A leaking pipe can lose hundreds of litres in a single day without anyone noticing. Washing a vehicle with a bucket instead of a hose, and watering plants with the water used to rinse vegetables, are simple ways of making every drop do two jobs.

Communities have done even more. In parts of Rajasthan, villagers revived old johads, small earthen dams that catch the monsoon rain, and found that wells which had been dry for years slowly filled again. Rooftop rainwater harvesting in schools and homes works on the same principle: water is not made, only moved, and the wise person moves it to where it will be needed. The lesson is that no city is too large and no village too small to begin.

The question of fairness cannot be ignored either. A family in a posh colony may use a bucketful for a plant while a family in a slum queues for a single pot at the public tap. When supply is short, it is the poor who suffer first and longest. Governments must therefore mend leaking pipelines, price water sensibly and make sure that the last house in the lane is not forgotten. Citizens, in turn, must treat water as a shared trust rather than a private right to be spent without thought.

Fortunately, ordinary people can help. Fixing a leaking tap can save thousands of litres in a year. Collecting rainwater from rooftops refills wells and keeps groundwater alive. Reusing the water used for washing vegetables to water plants costs nothing. Schools can teach children to switch off a running tap while brushing their teeth. A country that saves its water saves its future.

(i) What percentage of the Earth's water is in the oceans? 1

(a) about 10 per cent **(b)** about 50 per cent

(c) about 97 per cent **(d)** about 30 per cent

(ii) Water in the oceans is not useful because it is: 1

(a) too cold **(b)** too deep **(c)** too salty **(d)** too far

(iii) In many Indian cities taps run for: 1

(a) once a week **(b)** an hour or two each day

(c) all day **(d)** only at night

(iv) Who often walk long distances to fetch water in villages? 1

(a) Soldiers **(b)** Women and children

(c) Old people **(d)** Only men

(v) Which of these helps recharge groundwater? 1

(a) Building more roads **(b)** Collecting rainwater from rooftops

(c) Cutting trees **(d)** Using more tankers

(vi) Where is most of the remaining fresh water found? 1

(vii) What happens when rain fails? 1

(viii) Give one way to reuse household water. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'a long way off'. 1

(x) What is the writer's final message? 1

(xi) A johad is a: 1

(a) water pump **(b)** river boat

(c) small earthen dam that catches rain **(d)** type of well

(xii) Give one simple way mentioned of making every drop of water do two jobs. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

Anand lives in a small town and cycles to school every day. Last month the town administration introduced a bicycle-sharing scheme. Forty cycles were placed at four stands near the railway station, the market, the hospital and the school. Any resident can unlock a cycle with a mobile application, ride it and leave it at any stand. The first thirty minutes cost five rupees, and every additional fifteen minutes cost three rupees.

Anand's friend Zoya, who lives near the market, uses the scheme to reach school in fifteen minutes instead of waiting half an hour for a crowded bus. On Sunday she rode to the hospital to visit her uncle and returned in forty-five minutes of total riding time. For this she paid five rupees for the first thirty minutes and three rupees for the extra fifteen minutes. The administration says that in the first month more than nine hundred rides were recorded, and that most of them were on weekdays between seven and nine in the morning.

Some residents, however, complained that stands near the hospital are often empty by noon. The administration has promised to move cycles from crowded stands to empty ones every evening and to add twenty more cycles next month.

(i) How many cycle stands were set up? 1

(a) Four **(b)** Forty **(c)** Six **(d)** Two

(ii) The first thirty minutes of a ride cost: 1

(a) ten rupees **(b)** three rupees **(c)** eight rupees **(d)** five rupees

(iii) Most rides in the first month were taken: 1

(a) during school hours **(b)** on Sunday evenings

(c) after midnight **(d)** on weekdays between seven and nine in the morning

(iv) Which complaint did residents make? 1

(a) Stands near the hospital are often empty by noon **(b)** Cycles are too costly

(c) There are too many stands **(d)** Cycles have no brakes

(v) How is a cycle unlocked? 1

(vi) Calculate the total amount Zoya paid for her Sunday ride. 1

(vii) How will the administration solve the problem of empty stands? 1

(viii) Why does Zoya prefer the scheme to the bus? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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